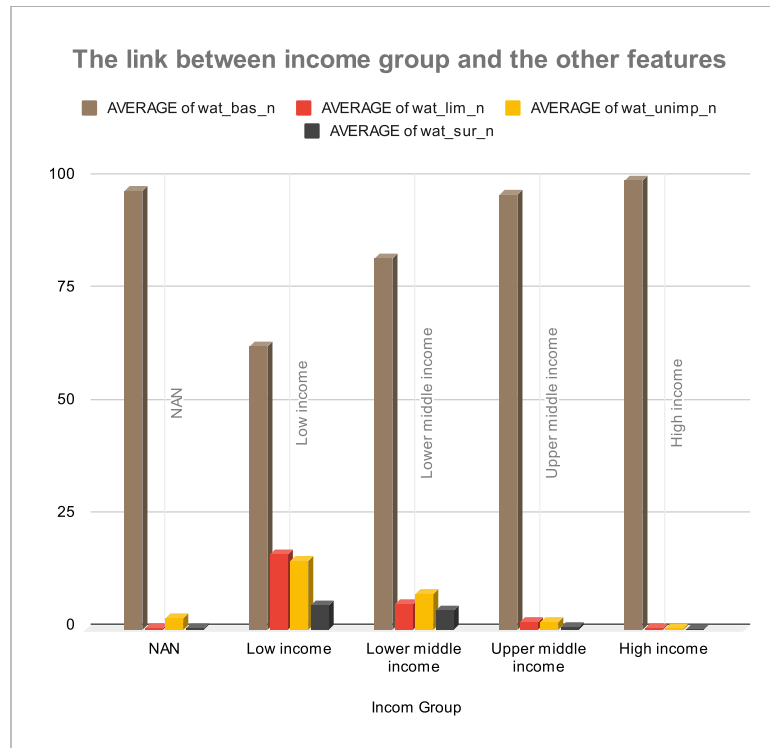


income_group_n	income_group	SUM of pop_n	AVERAGE of pop_u	AVERAGE of wat_bas_n	AVERAGE of wat_lim_n	AVERAGE of wat_unimp_n	AVERAGE of wat_sur_n
0	NAN	37264.34029	61.46049964	97.1814662	0.1482198143	2.386919485	0.3238794261
1	Low income	590425.1621	36.04465338	62.81937356	16.54838821	15.21093083	5.421307393
2	Lower middle inc	3399310.231	48.78990351	82.21049288	5.688425074	7.898143786	4.285348813
3	Upper middle inc	2547619.307	64.68569565	96.430472	1.561189554	1.483406065	0.5726535552
4	High income	1212076.068	79.35545728	99.56019792	0.1769010855	0.2408458913	0.02205537705

richer income groups tend to be more urbanized. Urbanization often makes it easier to provide piped and improved services at scale, so this can partly explain why water access improves with income (but income remains the strongest driver).



As income group increases, basic access rises, and limited/unimproved/surface decrease sharply.

This means income level is strongly linked to access quality: the “problem” categories are concentrated mainly in low income and partly in lower middle income groups.

The pivot table shows a strong relationship between income group and drinking-water access. Low income countries have the lowest average basic access (≈63%) and the highest shares of limited, unimproved, and surface water. As income rises, basic access increases sharply (≈82% in lower-middle, ≈96% in upper-middle, ≈99.6% in high income), while unsafe categories fall toward zero. This supports the idea that higher national income is associated with stronger water infrastructure and safer service levels.